SUMMARY · MK 1 ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR & MANAGING PEOPLE · WEEK 2

Who Am I at Work? — Identity, Personality & Individual Differences

After general self-knowledge in Week 1, this week focuses on who we are at work. The main tool is DISC — a model to read your own and others' behavioral style, then adapt how you communicate and build teams.

Material

1 Big picture: from self-awareness to mutual awareness

The slides draw on *Scaling People* (Claire Hughes Johnson), splitting people matters into **basic organizational behavior principles** and the **core HR framework** (hiring, team building, development & performance management).

The flow: **Self-awareness → Mutual awareness.** Know yourself, then your colleagues, so the team understands each other. On top of that: knowing *manager vs leader*, and **building trust** — "say the thing you think you cannot say".

Workplace self-awareness has three layers: (1) **values**, (2) **personality** shaping work, leadership and decision style, (3) **competencies**.

2 Why focus on behavior rather than personality?

Personality lives inside people and is hard to measure. **Behavior** is **observable, developable, changeable and controllable**. As a manager it's more useful to focus on what people *do*. DISC is behavior-based, so it fits.

3 The DISC model: origins and logic

The roots are old: Hippocrates (~400 BC) proposed four temperaments. In 1928 **William Moulton Marston** built DISC from two questions: is the environment seen as **favorable or unfavorable**, and is the response **active or passive**?

	Unfavorable	Favorable
Active	**D – Dominant**	**I – Influencing**
Passive	**C – Compliant**	**S – Steady**

Walter Clarke turned it into an assessment in the 1940s; it became popular in I/O psychology.

4 The DISC map: two simple questions Deep dive

DISC comes from two questions: pace (fast/assertive vs calm/careful) and focus (task vs people).

↕ Top: calm & careful · bottom: fast & assertive

C
Accurate, analytical.

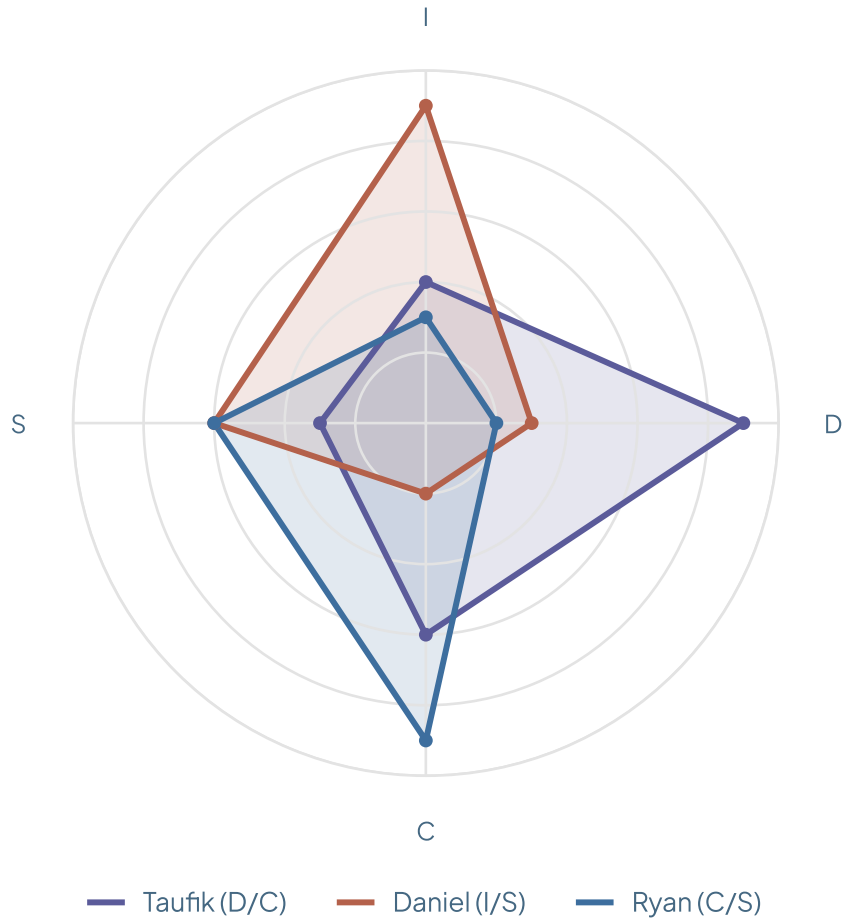
S
Steady, patient.

D
Decisive, results.

I
Enthusiastic, persuasive.

↔ Left: task focus · right: people focus

Task-force DISC profiles (illustrative)



Illustrative scores derived from the primary and secondary types.

Illustrative profiles of the task-force candidates: complementary, but low on S.

5 The four DISC types in detail

D — Dominant (Red)

How they solve problems and face challenges.
High ego, seeks authority, impatient, likes change, multitasks, handles direct confrontation. **Fear:** being taken advantage of. **Challenge:** gathering data before deciding.

I — Influencing (Yellow)

How they influence and persuade.
Emotional, people-oriented, optimistic, encouraging, often disorganized. **Fear:** rejection. **Challenge:** non-verbal communication and detail.

S — Steady (Green)

C — Compliant (Blue)

The pace at which they take on tasks.
Loyal, gentle team player, trusting, good listener, can be possessive. **Fear:** loss of security. **Challenge:** rapid change.

How they respond to rules.
Perfectionist, accurate, sensitive, needs explanations, asks many questions, analytical. **Fear:** criticism. **Challenge:** independence.

Most people are a **blend** — one primary and one secondary style (e.g. "High D, secondary C").

6 The three DISC graphs: mask, core, mirror

- **Graph 1 – "The Mask" (public self):** the image you want to show; changes with context.
- **Graph 2 – "The Core" (private self):** your natural reaction, especially under pressure. Least changeable.
- **Graph 3 – "The Mirror" (perceived self):** how you see yourself — past experience plus current demands. Evolves slowly.

A big gap between graphs 1 and 2 means you're "acting" hard at work — tiring, and a possible stress signal.

7 How to deal with each type

Type	Do	Don't
D	Brief, direct; ask "what" not "how"; focus on results and logical benefits; agree with facts, not the person.	Repeat yourself, over-socialize, generalize.
I	Friendly climate; let them talk ideas and people; testimonials; social time; write details without dwelling; incentives to follow through.	Cut social time, do all the talking, ignore their ideas.

S	Genuine interest; ask "how"; draw out goals patiently; time to adjust; define roles and procedures; personal follow-up; minimize perceived risk.	Be pushy, aggressive or demanding.
C	Prepare in advance; pros and cons; accurate data; "no surprises"; precise, patient explanations; disagree with facts, not the person.	Refuse detail, answer vaguely.

The slides also mention **OCEAN / Big Five** — more scientifically robust; DISC is more practical day-to-day.

8 Under stress: how behaviour shifts and how to adapt

Deep dive

Type	Need	Under stress	What helps
D	Control	Pushes harder	Be brief, give options
I	Recognition	Over-talks, skips detail	Praise, written summaries
S	Stability	Goes quiet, resists change	Explain why, give time
C	Accuracy	Over-critical, paralysis	Data and clear deadlines

Platinum rule

Treat others as they want to be treated.

vs

Golden rule

Fails when styles differ.

From the case

Agree an analysis time-box so Taufik (D) gets speed and Ryan (C) gets rigour.

9 DISC word bank: recognising types from how people talk and work

The slides list adjectives for each colour. Use them to "read" people without a test — listen to the words they use and watch how they work.

Colour / type	Adjectives from the slides (selection)	Typical line
Red – Dominant	Ambitious, strong-willed, goal-oriented, problem-solver, pioneer, decisive, innovator, impatient, controlling, results-oriented, fast, straightforward, independent	"What's the bottom line? When is it done?"
Yellow – Influencing	Talkative, enthusiastic, persuasive, creative, optimistic, spontaneous, expressive, charming, needs attention, encouraging, flexible, imaginative	"This is exciting! Who else can we bring in?"
Green – Steady	Patient, relaxed, self-controlled, reliable, loyal, modest, stable, prudent, supportive, good listener, persistent, conceals feelings	"How will this affect the team? Let's take it step by step."
Blue – Compliant	Conscientious, systematic, distant, correct, conventional, objective, structured, analytical, perfectionist, needs time, methodical, seeks facts, follows rules	"Where's the data from? Does this follow procedure?"

! **Limits of DISC**

DISC helps everyday communication, but it is not a strong selection tool. Results shift with context (the "mask" graph), and scientific research relies more on the Big Five. Don't reject candidates or place people *only* on DISC — use it to start conversations.

10 OCEAN / Big Five: the most scientifically robust personality model

The slides mention the **OCEAN Model** without much detail. It's the most widely used model in personality research. Everyone has a score on five dimensions (not a "type"):

Dimension	High score	Low score	Link to work
Openness to experience	Curious, imaginative, likes new ideas	Practical, prefers the proven	Linked to creativity and learning new things
Conscientiousness	Organised, disciplined, responsible	Spontaneous, less structured	**The most consistent predictor of performance** across almost all jobs (Barrick & Mount meta-analysis, 1991)
Extraversion	Energetic, sociable, assertive	Quiet, comfortable alone	Helps in sales and managerial roles; not required for technical roles
Agreeableness	Friendly, cooperative, trusting	Competitive, critical, sceptical	Helps teamwork and service; very high may struggle to say "no"
Neuroticism (opposite: emotional stability)	Anxious, stress-sensitive	Calm, stable	Emotional stability helps in high-pressure jobs

DISC vs Big Five

DISC

- Focuses on visible behaviou
- Four types, easy to remembe and use in meetings

Big Five (OCEAN)

- Focuses on personality traits
- Five continuous scales, more detailed
- Good for research, selection and development
- Backed by decades of cross-cultural research

- Good for communi and team building
- Limited scientific support

Link to Week 7's slides: *conscientiousness* better predicts who rises in the informal hierarchy in task-oriented organisations (for example engineering firms), while *extraversion* predicts it better in socially oriented ones (consulting, sales).

11 Manager vs leader, and building trust

Week 2's slides name two things above self-awareness: **knowing the difference between manager and leader** and **building trust**. In detail:

Function	Management (coping with complexity)	Leadership (coping with change)
Setting direction	Planning and budgeting	Setting vision and strategy
Organising people	Structure and staffing	Aligning people with the vision (communication)
Execution	Controlling and problem solving	Motivating and inspiring

This split comes from John Kotter (1990, "What Leaders Really Do"). Both are needed: an organisation managed but not led becomes rigid; one led but not managed becomes chaotic. A manager in a state-owned enterprise usually has to do both.

"Say the thing you think you cannot say"

This *Scaling People* principle means trust grows when hard things are discussed openly rather than held back. Workplace examples:

- "I'm worried this target isn't realistic, and here's why…"
- "I feel my contribution to this project isn't visible." (what Kana should have told Pak Bram in Week 3's case)
- "My fast pace may make you feel pushed — tell me when that happens."

A simple way to practise *mutual awareness*: each team member writes a one-page "how to work with me" — best working hours, how they take criticism, DISC type, pet peeves — and shares it with the team. It speeds up getting to know each other, which normally takes months.

Key takeaways

1. Flow: self-awareness → mutual awareness → team trust.
2. Focus on behavior because it's observable and changeable.
3. DISC = environment (favorable/unfavorable) × response (active/passive).
4. D = results; I = people & persuasion; S = stability & pace; C = rules & accuracy.
5. Three graphs: Mask (public), Core (natural/under pressure), Mirror (self-perception).
6. Adapt communication to the other person's style.
7. Effective teams = complementary types in fitting roles.

Case studies

Case & worked answers

DISC case: forming a digitalization task force (Ryan, Daniel, Taufik)

Situation: As ICT Section Head you form a digitalization task force with an external consultant. Candidates:

- **Ryan** (40, Senior Network Architect) — **High C**, secondary S: detailed, structured, avoids conflict, works alone.
- **Daniel** (30, Programmer) — **High I**, secondary S: outgoing, relational, less structured, misses detail.
- **Taufik** (31, System Analyst) — **High D**, secondary C: decisive, goal-driven, takes charge, impatient.

A reasonable analysis:

1. **Coordinator → Taufik**: decisive drive; secondary C keeps quality in view.
2. **Conflicts:** Taufik vs Ryan (speed vs analysis; Ryan goes quiet when he disagrees); Taufik vs Daniel (detail). *Mitigate:* written roles and deadlines, defined analysis time for Ryan, structure/checklists for Daniel, regular forums where Ryan is asked directly.
3. **Consultant counterpart → Daniel**: relationship-building and bridging — I's strength; back him with minutes/checklists.
4. **Database → Ryan**: precise, structured work suited to High C.

Lesson: good teams combine **complementary types in fitting roles**; the leader manages the inevitable friction.

Practice questions

Try answering first. The answer key is below each question.

1. Fast, assertive and results-focused suggests type…

A. D
B. I
C. S
D. C

Answer: A. Fast + task = Dominance.

2. Why focus on behaviour rather than personality?

A. Behaviour can't be observed
B. Behaviour is observable and adaptable
C. Personality changes daily
D. DISC measures IQ

Answer: B. Behaviour is visible and adaptable.

---

3. The external-consultant counterpart role best suits…

A. Ryan (C)
B. Daniel (I)
C. Taufik (D)
D. Anyone

Answer: B. It needs relationship-building, the I strength.

---

4. An S colleague goes quiet after a sudden change. Best approach…

A. Push for quick agreement
B. Explain reasons and steps, give time
C. Ignore it
D. Add tasks

Answer: B. S types need security and a clear process.

---

5. The platinum rule means…

A. Treat others as you want
B. Treat others as they want
C. Always follow the boss
D. Favour D types

Answer: B. Adapt to the other person's style.

Sources

- Week 2 - Identity, Personality, Behavior & Individual Differences.pdf